Learning Objectives

At the end of this lesson you shall be able to

- Understand the history of Highway Development in India
- List the classification of Roads
- Know the various geometrical designs used in Highways
- State the various types highway materials
- List the tests to be conducted on various road materials
- Explain the different types of Road construction
- Understand the purpose and methods of soil stabilization
- List the types of Road Signals and Road Signs
- Explain the causes and prevention of Road accidents
- Define Road Arboriculture and its uses
- Have an idea of Highway Lighting and its benefits

6.1 Introduction

Transportation is the movement of human, animals and goods from one place to another. The most common modes of transport are air, water and land transport. Other modes include pipelines, cable transport and space transport. Transportation plays an important role in the country's economic, industrial, social and cultural development.

6.1.1 Definition

Highway Engineering deals with the design, location, methods of construction and maintenance of all types of roads in plain country as well as in hilly areas.



6.1.2 Characteristics of road transport

1. Roads can be used for all types of vehicles like cars, buses, trucks, etc.,
2. Road transport requires a relatively small investment and maintenance cost when compared to other modes of transportation.
3. It offers flexibility of change in direction, location, speed and timings of travel.
4. It saves time for short distance travel.
5. Road transport is easily available to the public.

6.1.3 Uses of roads

1. They are important for country's overall development and economic prosperity.
2. A good network of roads helps in the defence of a country during war and peace time.
3. Better law and order can be maintained.

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